were incurred some by going bond in exchange for Charles when the latter was over due, some money borrowed and paid to Charles' creditors, for galls, shawls and other goods bought and sent to Constantinople and the proceeds paid against Charles' debts here, and all my debts as I can prove most fully were incurred directly or indirectly by the position in which Charles has placed me by taking out of Persia some £35,000 worth of property and not accounting for a sixpence. No "process of law" resembling "bankruptcy" has been instituted either against me or Charles either jointly or seperately. I have never been in prison, except when at Tehran the Hadji (Prime minister) refused to allow me to leave the town until Charles came. This was something like being a prisoner on parole. I have been at times much annoyed by my creditors dunning me, and owe it to the kind protection of the British and Persian Governments that nothing worse has happened to me. In Persia they flog debtors, and when they find they can get nothing out of them by such means they often get a quittance. In fact I think that the Persians are, taking the difference of manners into consideration, much more lenient than we were at least twenty years ago. Such horrible barbarity as keeping a man in prison all his life because he owed money and could not pay perhaps from no fault of his was never heard of in Persia. In fact there are few countries where a man has such a chance of getting out of difficulties as Persia. And I think that with a very little assistance from Charles I could pay all these debts.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tehran, March 31, 1849*

Thank God I have at last one of your letters to answer, I received yours of the 11*th* Dec the day before yesterday. You do not say anything about the property my Mother left and whether the letter certified by the British Consul at Tabreez was satisfactory or not. I mean that I wrote to uncle George Ridsdale appointing you my agent to act in this matter; What is the probable amount of the property? I know nothing about canal shares, what I grumble about so much in you and my father is that you will not answer even questions on business that I may put to you.

I am right glad you have not sold the shawl, it is worth twenty or perhaps much more here, if I recollect right I was offered sixty tomauns for it at Tabreez, this would be about £27 – – But it appears your friends the Americans don't know the value of such things. I am very glad Valeria has it and that it has not passed out of the family. These things are given to us as marks of approval of our conduct, and are worn once as scarfs, in the presence of the giver, whether King or Prince, and afterwards we do what we like with them, unfortunately I have been so ill off of late years that I have been obliged to sell mine. I sold two

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